

Difference Equations

FD into PDE $\Rightarrow$ (algebraic) difference equation

Example:

$$\frac{\partial T}{\partial t} = \alpha \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial x^2}$$

(1D HEAT EQN.)

1st-order fwd. FD in t (marching variable):

$$\left(\frac{\partial T}{\partial t} \right)_{i,n}^{\text{time index}} = \frac{T_i^{n+1} - T_i^n}{\Delta t} + O(\Delta t)$$

x-index

2nd-order central 2nd FD in x :

$$\left(\frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial x^2} \right)_i^n = \frac{T_{i+1}^n - 2T_i^n + T_{i-1}^n}{\Delta x^2} + O(\Delta x^2)$$

FD's into PDE:

PDE

$$\frac{\partial T}{\partial t} = \alpha \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial x^2}$$

$$\frac{T_i^{n+1} - T_i^n}{\Delta t} = \alpha \frac{T_{i+1}^n - 2T_i^n + T_{i-1}^n}{\Delta x^2}$$

difference eqn.

$+ \underbrace{O(\Delta t, \Delta x^2)}_{TE}$

- observe that as $\Delta x \rightarrow 0$, $\Delta t \rightarrow 0 \Rightarrow TE \rightarrow 0$
 $\Rightarrow$ difference eqn. (FDE) is consistent
 (we recover original PDE)

- we say FDE "first-order accurate in time and second-order accurate in space"

Explicit time marching

solve for T_i^{n+1}
 $\Rightarrow$

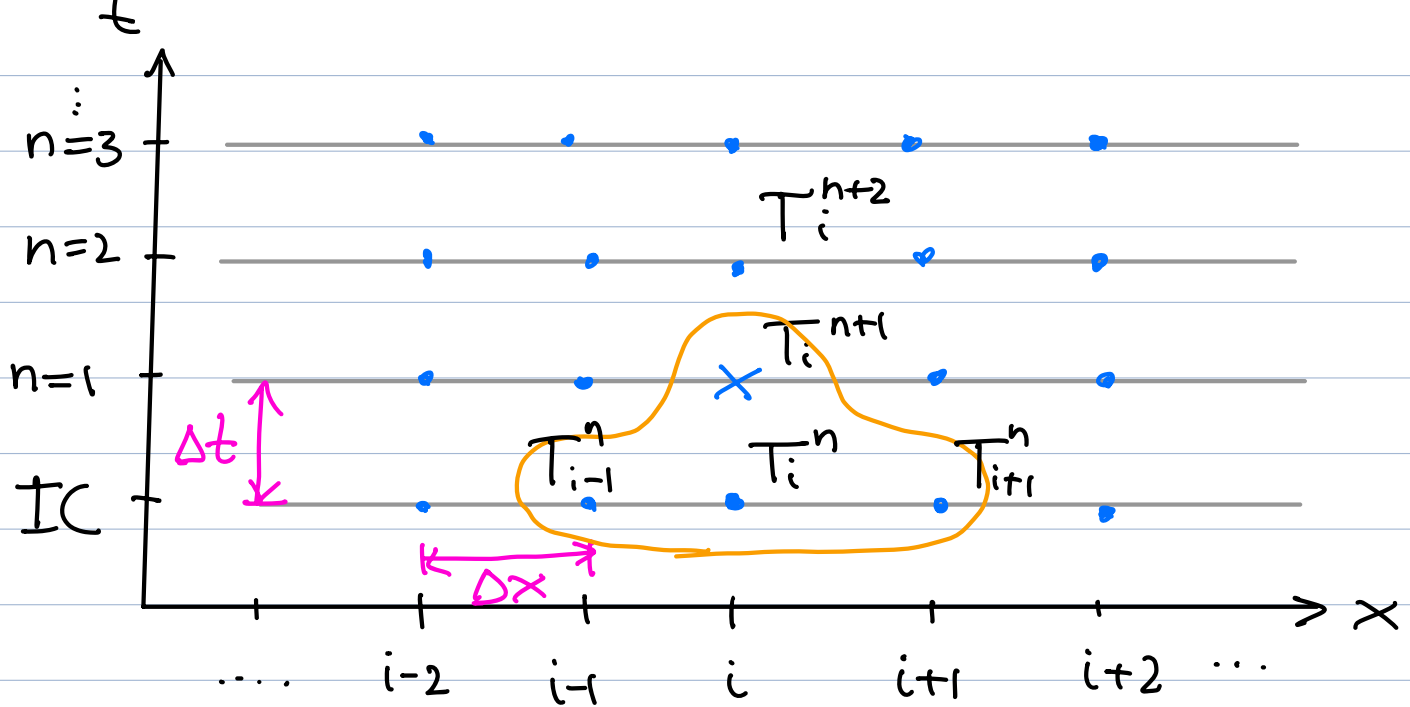
$$T_i^{n+1} = T_i^n + \underbrace{\alpha \frac{\Delta t}{\Delta x^2}}_{\text{const.}} (T_{i+1}^n - 2T_i^n + T_{i-1}^n)$$

unknown

known from time level n
 $(n=1 \rightarrow IC)$

EULER EXPLICIT

- start computation with IC : $T_i^{n=1} = T_i^{IC}$



stability requirement:

$$\frac{\alpha \Delta t}{\Delta x^2} \leq \frac{1}{2}$$

2-D Heat conduction

(= 2D diffusion eqn.)

temperature

const. heat diffusivity

PDE

$$\frac{\partial T}{\partial t} = \alpha \left(\frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial y^2} \right)$$

2D HEAT EQN.

Difference eqn. (Euler explicit)

$$T_{i,j}^{n+1} = T_{i,j}^n + \alpha \frac{\Delta t}{\Delta x^2} (T_{i+1,j}^n - 2T_{i,j}^n + T_{i-1,j}^n)$$

$\nearrow$ $\nwarrow$
 x-index y-index

$$+ \alpha \frac{\Delta t}{\Delta y^2} (T_{i,j+1} - 2T_{i,j} + T_{i,j-1})$$

stability requirement

$$\frac{\alpha \Delta t}{\Delta x^2} + \frac{\alpha \Delta t}{\Delta y^2} \leq \frac{1}{2}$$

accuracy : $O(\Delta t, \Delta x^2, \Delta y^2)$

1-D advection

concentration bulk velocity

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = -u_0 \frac{\partial c}{\partial x}$$

PDE

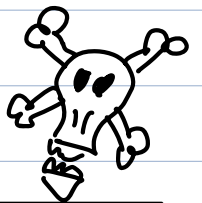
1-D LINEAR ADVECTION

Difference eqn.

- Euler explicit (fwd. first-order in time)
 - second-order central FD in x
- $\Rightarrow O(\Delta t, \Delta x^2)$

unknown

$$\frac{c_i^{n+1} - c_i^n}{\Delta t} = -u_0 \frac{c_{i+1}^n - c_{i-1}^n}{2\Delta x}$$



$$\Rightarrow c_i^{n+1} = c_i^n - \frac{u_0 \Delta t}{2\Delta x} (c_{i+1}^n - c_{i-1}^n)$$

stability requirement: UNCONDITIONALLY UNSTABLE!

MacCormack's method (1969)
(explicit FD, $O(\Delta t^2, \Delta x^2)$)

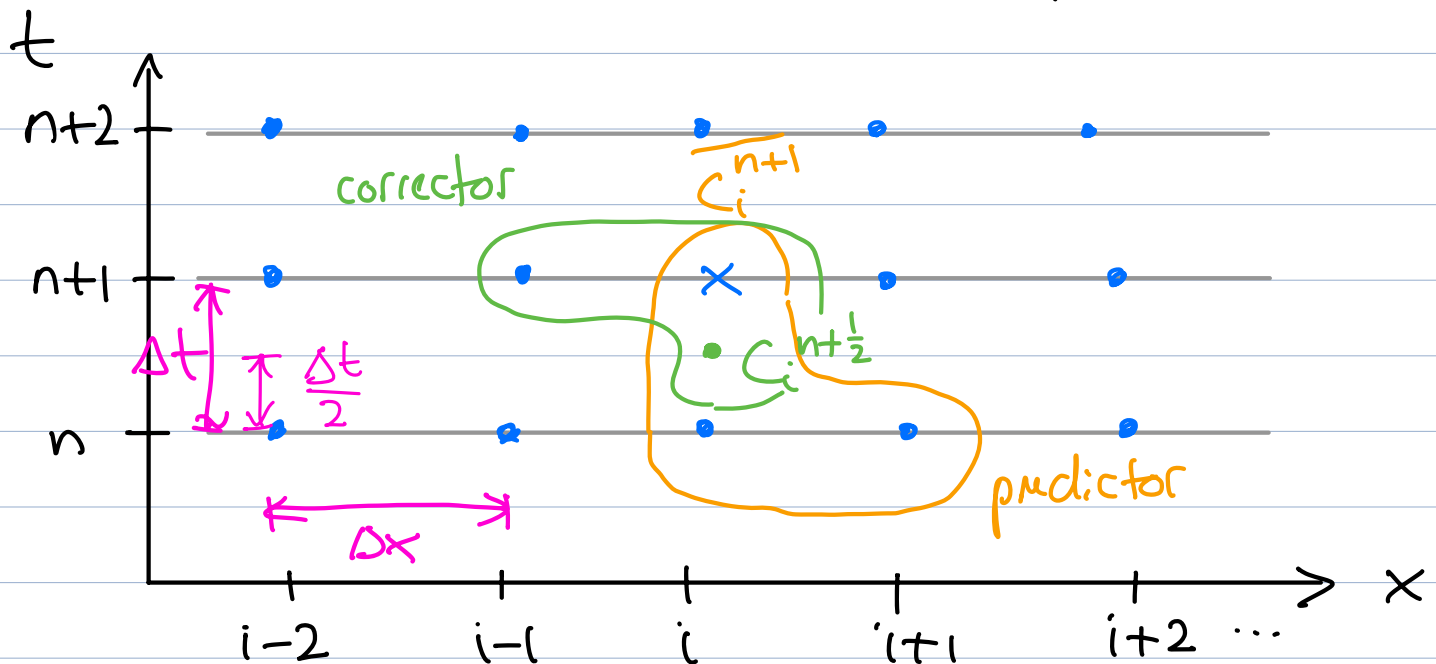
Example:

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} + u_0 \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} = 0$$

1D ADVECTION EQN.



use first-order FD's for t & x , but introduce an intermediate time step!



• Step 1: forward FD's in t & x (explicit Euler)

$$\frac{c_i^{n+1} - c_i^n}{\Delta t} = u_0 \frac{c_{i+1}^n - c_i^n}{\Delta x}$$

(pl)

Δt
use as temporary,
or 'predicted' soln.

Δx

- Step 2: forward in t from $n+\frac{1}{2}$ to n over $\frac{\Delta t}{2}$
and backward in x

$$\frac{C_i^{n+1} - C_i^{n+\frac{1}{2}}}{\frac{1}{2}\Delta t} = -u_0 \frac{\overline{C_i^{n+1}} - \overline{C_{i-1}^{n+1}}}{\Delta x} \quad (C1)$$

solve for C_i^{n+1}

$$\Rightarrow C_i^{n+1} = C_i^{n+\frac{1}{2}} - \frac{1}{2} \frac{u_0 \Delta t}{\Delta x} (\overline{C_i^{n+1}} - \overline{C_{i-1}^{n+1}})$$



approximate $n+\frac{1}{2}$ as average

$$C_i^{n+\frac{1}{2}} \approx \frac{1}{2} (C_i^n + \overline{C_i^{n+1}})$$

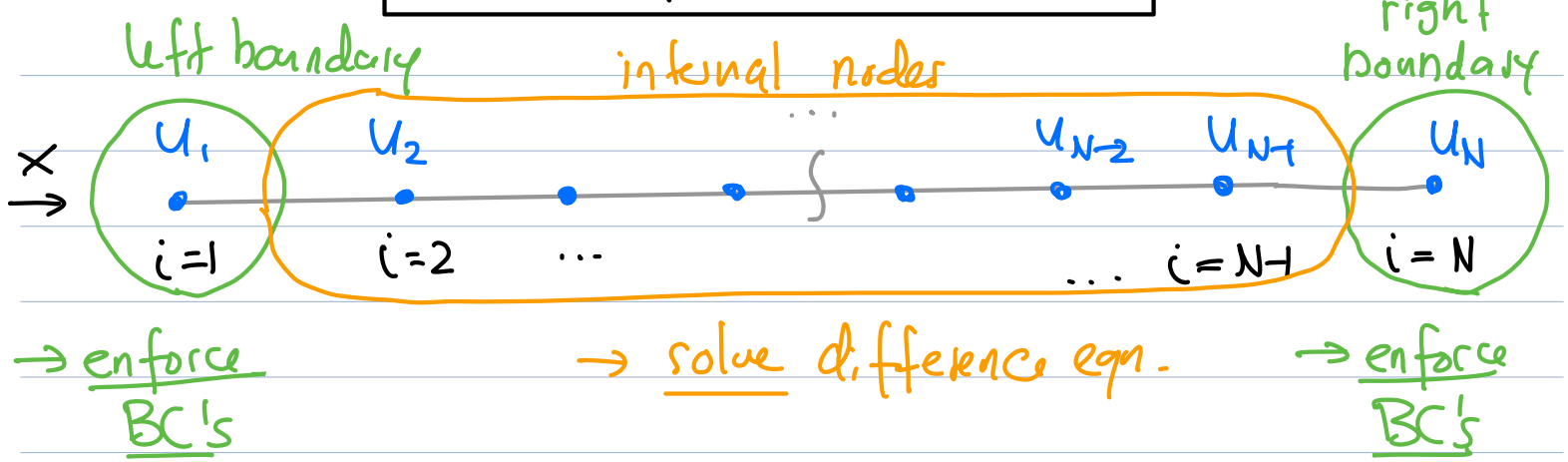
Predictor

$$\overline{C_i^{n+1}} = C_i^n - \frac{u_0 \Delta t}{\Delta x} (C_{i+1}^n - C_i^n)$$

Corrector

$$C_i^{n+1} = \frac{1}{2} \left[(C_i^n + \overline{C_i^{n+1}}) - \frac{u_0 \Delta t}{\Delta x} (\overline{C_i^{n+1}} - \overline{C_{i-1}^{n+1}}) \right]$$

Boundary conditions



- constant value (or Dirichlet) BC

$$u = \text{const.}$$

Ex.: i) no-slip condition (zero velocity) at bottom wall

$$u(x, y=0) = 0 \Rightarrow u_{i,j=1} = 0$$

$$(v_{i,j=1} = 0)$$

ii) const. wall temperature

$$T(x, y=0) = T_{\text{wall}} \Rightarrow T_{i,j=1} = T_{\text{wall}}$$

- constant gradient (or Neumann) BC

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} = \text{const.}$$

Ex.: adiabatic wall (no heat flux) at $y=0$

→ Fourier's law

heat flux $[\frac{W}{m^2}]$ $\rightarrow \dot{q}_y = -k \left(\frac{\partial T}{\partial y} \right)_{y=0} = 0$ $\leftarrow$ temperature gradient

therm. conduct.

$$\Rightarrow \left(\frac{\partial T}{\partial y} \right)_{y=0} = 0$$

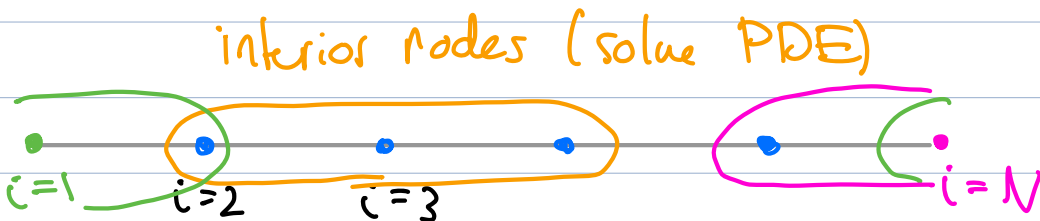
fwld FD $O(\Delta y)$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{T_{i,2} - T_{i,1}}{\Delta y} = 0 \Rightarrow T_{i,2} = T_{i,1}$$

- periodic (not really a BC, but replaces BC)
→ get implemented in FD in difference eqn.

Ex:

$$\frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial x^2} \approx \frac{T_{i+1} - 2T_i + T_{i-1}}{\Delta x^2}$$

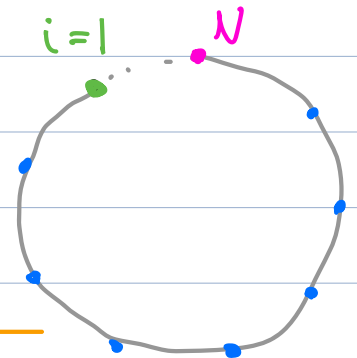


Ex:

$$\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} \approx \frac{u_{i+1} - 2u_i + u_{i-1}}{2\Delta x}$$

interior :

$$\left. \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} \right|_{i=3} \approx \frac{u_4 - 2u_3 + u_2}{2\Delta x}$$



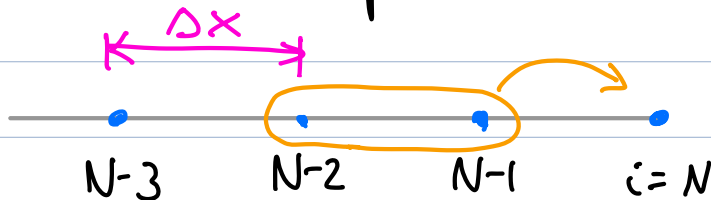
left :

$$\left. \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} \right|_{i=1} \approx \frac{u_2 - 2u_1 + u_N}{2\Delta x}$$

right: $\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} \Big|_{i=N} \approx \frac{u_1 - 2u_N + u_{N-1}}{2\Delta x}$

• extrapolation (last resort...)

Ex.: linear extrapolation at right boundary



: construct line from N-2 to N through N-1

$$u_N \approx u_{N-1} + \underbrace{\frac{u_{N-1} - u_{N-2}}{\Delta x}}_{\text{fwd. diff for slope}} \underbrace{2\Delta x}_{\text{distance}}$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{u_N \approx -u_{N-2} + 2u_{N-1}} \quad (\text{right})$$

$$\boxed{u_1 \approx -u_3 + 2u_2} \quad (\text{left})$$